

appreciate or know. For a very long time, until after I came to temporarily own the book's rights and then, subsequently, got into a dumb fight with Jack McDonald (which was my fault), Jack always used *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* as a formal or informal Stanford textbook for the course. Over the years—not every year, but for many years—Father drove down to Stanford at Jack's request to deliver an annual lecture and answer questions in Jack's class. In May 2000, after many years of absence and with Father well into dementia, Jack asked him to return and lecture. I was scared to death Father would embarrass himself because I knew he wasn't at all the man he used to be. But Father rose to the occasion and had one of his best days in a long time, delivering a rousing lecture and answering all questions from all comers. The whole thing, including Jack's warm introduction of Father, was reprinted verbatim in volume XV, number 7, of the *Outstanding Investor Digest*.

As Father's dementia overtook him, he slowly lost more of the memories of past businesspeople he had known. For the most part, the earlier he knew them, the longer he remembered them, and the most recent acquaintances faded first from memory. For example, he remembered many people from the 1950's, whereas he had forgotten pretty much everyone he had known from the 1970's. Dementia is like that. But more emotional memories are embedded deeper in the mind; and Jack McDonald, whom Father met in 1961, thirty-three years into a seventy-two-year career, was one of the very last business personas to fade from his recollection, demonstrating how much McDonald meant to him.

As the 1960's passed, Father became ever less interested in his public image and more interested in being quiet. He fancied himself a great judge of businesspeople and largely was, but he knew that was a private activity. He responded to few local requests for appearances but declined ever more of them, and he wouldn't travel to appear in public ever again. In 1970, at sixty-three, he still didn't have a gray hair on his head. That same year, my oldest brother, Arthur, an ecclesiastical historian by training and a very good one, went to work to join him. Two years later, I joined. Father's vision was that we would work for a few years and then slowly take over his business. That could never happen. It took me only about a year to realize why. Father was such a stickler for detail and so focused and so socially awkward and insecure that he was absolutely incapable of delegating in any